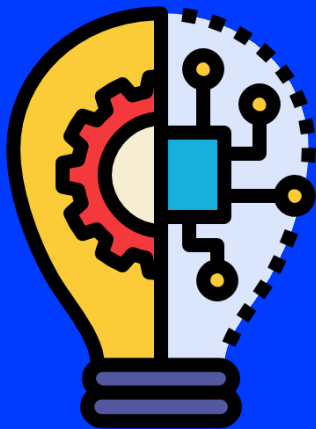




SOLUTION TRACK

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SOLUTION TRACK

Introduction

Welcome to the Solution Track of the Epitech Innovative Project (EIP) – where technology meets real-world impact. This track empowers you to develop innovative solutions that address genuine problems, whether societal, environmental, or industry-specific. Your mission is to create a project that doesn't just work technically, but resonates with users, solves meaningful challenges, and builds lasting engagement.

The Solution Track focuses on the human side of technology. While your code forms the foundation, success here means understanding your users deeply, crafting experiences they love, and building a community that believes in your vision. You'll learn to think like a product manager, a community builder, and a user advocate – skills that transform good developers into exceptional solution creators.

This journey will challenge you to master multiple dimensions of product development. You'll conduct user research to validate your assumptions, design and iterate on user experiences based on real feedback, build and nurture an engaged community, establish strategic partnerships that amplify your impact, and create visibility strategies that help your solution find its audience. Each aspect is crucial for transforming a technical project into a solution that truly matters.

This guide provides a comprehensive framework for your Solution Track journey, detailing both **mandatory objectives** that form the core of your assessment and **complementary goals** you'll select with your mentor to match your project's unique needs. Clear deliverables and evaluation criteria ensure you understand what excellence looks like at every step.

Remember that alongside these solution-focused objectives, you'll continue advancing your technical development. The workload will ebb and flow throughout the year, with some periods demanding more intensive effort. Strong organizational skills and open communication with your mentor and the EIP academic coordinator will be your keys to success. They are here to challenge your assumptions, refine your strategies, and help you navigate the complex but rewarding path of building solutions that matter.

Mandatory Objectives to Achieve

1. Develop and Retain a User Community

Identification & Targeting

- ✓ **Define one or more user personas:** target profiles, expectations, friction points, preferred channels.
- ✓ **Clarify the community value proposition:** why should this community follow and interact with your project?

Launch & Run Community Channels

- ✓ **Create and actively run at least two channels** suited to your target (Discord, LinkedIn, Instagram, TikTok, newsletter, forum, etc.).
- ✓ **Build a consistent community identity:**
 - logo,
 - editorial tone,
 - visuals,
 - posting cadence,
 - language style.
- ✓ **Define a structured content plan**, including:
 - a clear editorial line (themes, formats, goals),
 - a regular frequency (e.g., 2 posts/week),
 - varied formats (carousel, short video, poll, testimonial, tutorial, behind-the-scenes),
 - objectives per content type (awareness, engagement, conversion, feedback, etc.).

Acquisition & Activation of Beta Testers

- ✓ **Deploy a targeted recruitment strategy** (social campaigns, test calls, outreach in community, etc.).
- ✓ **Minimum objective:** 20 beta testers identified, onboarded, and active.
- ✓ **Design a clear beta-test journey:** test → feedback → adjustment.
- ✓ **Offer incentives** (early access, badge, shout-out, VIP access, etc.).

Tracking, Measurement & Retention

- ✓ **Set up a community activity dashboard:** member count, participation rate, likes, views, messages, user feedback.
- ✓ **Regularly feed community insights into the roadmap.**
- ✓ **Run retention actions:** exclusive content, acknowledgments, co-creation of features.

Expected Deliverables (Non-exhaustive)

- ✓ **Persona/segmentation sheets** (PDF or slides).
- ✓ **Links to active community channels.**
- ✓ **Editorial content plan** (Excel/Notion/Miro).
- ✓ **Post captures** (TikTok/Instagram/Discord, etc.).
- ✓ **Community activity dashboard** (members, retention rate, analytics).
- ✓ **List of activated beta testers** (emails/handles/roles).
- ✓ **Onboarding sheet or test form.**
- ✓ **Consolidated user feedback.**
- ✓ **Synthesis of actions taken from community feedback.**

What Is Not Sufficient

- ✓ Opening a Discord without animation or moderation.
- ✓ Posting a few visuals with no interaction or planning.
- ✓ Showing follower counts without engagement proof.
- ✓ “Ghost” beta testers (no tracking or structured feedback).

2. Improve User Experience (UX/UI)

User-Centered Approach

- ✓ **Establish a structured UX process** grounded in identified user needs.
- ✓ **Build realistic usage scenarios:** how users interact, in what context, with what expectations.
- ✓ **Create a user journey (experience map)** including friction points, key moments, and intended emotions.

High-quality Prototyping

- ✓ **Produce an interactive prototype or hi-fi mockup** (Figma, Adobe XD, etc.).
- ✓ **Apply modern UX/UI principles:**
 - simplicity, accessibility, clear hierarchy,
 - responsive design, micro-interactions, visual feedback.
- ✓ **Present an interface that is clear, intuitive, and visually polished**, consistent with the project branding.

User Tests & Iterations

- ✓ **Conduct at least 5 real user tests** on the prototype or a functional V1.
- ✓ **Collect feedback** via observation, interviews, or analytics tools (Maze, Hotjar, Google Forms, etc.).
- ✓ **Perform at least two significant iterations** based on feedback.
- ✓ **Document what was changed, removed, or improved.**

Documentation & Continuous Improvement

- ✓ **Present a UX synthesis:** issues found, priorities, trade-offs.
- ✓ **Set up a UX backlog** (list of next improvements).
- ✓ **Align with community/beta-tester feedback** gathered on your channels.

Expected Deliverables (Non-exhaustive)

- ✓ Illustrated **user journey / experience map**.
- ✓ **Wireframes/prototypes/mockups** (Figma, Webflow, etc.).
- ✓ **User test scenarios + analysis grids**.
- ✓ **Test captures/recordings** (or verbatims).
- ✓ **Synthesis of feedback + table of changes made**.
- ✓ **Remaining UX priorities** (UX backlog).
- ✓ **Version comparison (v1, v2, ...)** with rationale.
- ✓ **Links to tested versions or public interfaces**.

What Is Not Sufficient

- ✓ Showing a mockup without any real test.
- ✓ Only changing colors or fonts unrelated to feedback.
- ✓ Anecdotal feedback without documentation (“someone said...”).
- ✓ A “pretty” UI that is unusable or misaligned with the target.
- ✓ No iteration or benchmark performed.

Complementary Objectives

(2 to be chosen by the group, in consultation with the mentor)

1. Increase Visibility & Impact on Social Media

Build a Visibility Strategy

- ✓ **Define external targets** (e.g., sector professionals, non-Epitech students, engaged actors, net-new potential users).
- ✓ **Deliberately choose high-reach channels** (TikTok, LinkedIn, Instagram, Twitter/X, YouTube, etc.) with justification.
- ✓ **Design a diffusion strategy** to:
 - maximize reach (organic, hashtags, trends),
 - generate resonance (reposts, mentions, reactions),
 - multiply touchpoints with the project.

Produce High-impact Content

- ✓ **Publish ≥ 5 outward-facing posts** with varied formats: demo video, explanatory thread, manifesto, user testimonial, visual teaser.
- ✓ **Integrate viral/conversational elements:** storytelling, punchy lines, short engaging formats, prompts/questions.
- ✓ **Use suitable tools** (CapCut, Canva, Figma, Buffer, Meta Suite, etc.).

Track & Analyze Impact

- ✓ **Use each platform's analytics** to measure reach, interactions, performance.
- ✓ **Deliver an impact synthesis:** reach achieved, interaction types, notable feedback.
- ✓ **Extract learnings** to adjust the project's communication strategy.

Expected Deliverables (Non-exhaustive)

- ✓ **Visibility strategy note** or map of external targets.
- ✓ **Links/captures of public posts.**
- ✓ **Analytics screenshots** (reach, engagement, comments).
- ✓ **Review of formats used** (video, visual, text, carousel, poll...).
- ✓ **Impact synthesis:** which audiences reached? notable feedback?
- ✓ **Planned vs. actual impact comparison.**

What Is Not Sufficient

- ✓ Reposting community-only content from Discord or closed channels.
- ✓ Relying only on existing followers or project teammates.
- ✓ Posting with no clear objective or impact analysis.
- ✓ Using only personal network (friends/family/Epitech peers).
- ✓ Producing purely descriptive visuals with no differentiating message.

2. Establish Strategic Partnerships

Identify & Qualify Partners

- ✓ **Spot 2–3 relevant actors** in your project's environment (sector, territory, issue).
- ✓ **Clarify their value add:** expertise, audience, legitimacy, resources, field access.
- ✓ **Define the partnership type:** test, PoC, mentorship, relay, co-creation, distribution, introductions, joint event, etc.

Outreach & Commitment

- ✓ **Use a professional approach:** email, LinkedIn, call, meeting, project deck, clear ask.
- ✓ **Achieve at least one formalized collaboration** (even informally written).
- ✓ **Present the partnership clearly:** objectives, actions taken, reciprocal contributions.

Valorize the Partnership

- ✓ **Present concrete outcomes** (PoC, feedback, user access, co-development).
- ✓ **Evaluate impact:** how the partner helped unlock a step or strengthen a key point.
- ✓ **Optional:** seed a long-term partnership (roadmap integration, post-EIP meetings).

Expected Deliverables (Non-exhaustive)

- ✓ **Partner map** (profile, value, contact channel).
- ✓ **Outreach emails/captures and replies.**
- ✓ **Agreement or written trace** (email, video call notes, collab doc).
- ✓ **Partnership synthesis:** objectives, actions, mutual contributions.
- ✓ **Partner testimonial** (text, audio, video, quote).
- ✓ **Proof of what the partnership enabled** to test/validate/advance.

What Is Not Sufficient

- ✓ Citing a prestigious actor without real contact or exchange.
- ✓ Confusing user with partner.
- ✓ Presenting a discussion with no action or mutual commitment.
- ✓ Listing an Epitech stakeholder without a formal collaboration.
- ✓ Showing an unanswered email as “partnership proof”.

3. Optimizing Relationships with the Target Audience

Set Up a Structured Feedback System

- ✓ **Create one or more feedback channels:** form, Discord, chat, email, live sessions, interviews, polls, etc.
- ✓ **Establish a regular listening ritual:** monthly review, usage report, AMA, open discussion.
- ✓ **Precisely target respondents:** active users, testers, external stakeholders, high-value profiles.

Process & Integrate Feedback

- ✓ **Perform qualitative + quantitative analysis** (summary table, scoring, categorization).
- ✓ **Translate into concrete proposals** to improve product, messaging, or interface.
- ✓ **Present at least two evolutions** justified by recurring user requests/feedback.

Proximity & Transparency

- ✓ **Share project evolution regularly with the audience:** “here’s what we changed,” “thanks for your feedback,” “your idea was integrated...”.
- ✓ **Value contributors:** shout-outs, early access, badges, personal notes.
- ✓ **Build a durable relationship** with a small active core.

Expected Deliverables (Non-exhaustive)

- ✓ **Links to listening channels or forms.**
- ✓ **Feedback synthesis table** (verbatim, themes, frequencies).
- ✓ **Exchange captures, quotes, discussion excerpts.**
- ✓ **Decision summaries** derived from feedback.
- ✓ **Proof of evolution tied to feedback** (before/after, release notes).
- ✓ **Testimonials/thanks to contributors.**

What Is Not Sufficient

- ✓ Sending one survey with no follow-up or analysis.
- ✓ Collecting feedback but doing nothing with it.
- ✓ Listening only to team members or friends.
- ✓ Announcing changes without linking them to feedback.
- ✓ Failing to formalize the link between “said” and “done”.

4. Strengthening Credibility and Building the Project’s Reputation

External Channels & Presence

- ✓ **Identify specialized media, blogs, newsletters, podcasts, or sector platforms.**
- ✓ **Secure at least one public external trace:** article, interview, column, citation, talk.
- ✓ **Participate in an external event:** fair, competition, panel, public pitch, conference, hackathon.

Ecosystem Positioning

- ✓ **List the project on relevant platforms** (e.g., Product Hunt, Indie Hackers, DevPost, HelloAsso).
- ✓ **Create a professional project profile:** LinkedIn page, website, mini-portfolio.
- ✓ **Contact a recognized expert** for validation, feedback, or support (even one-off).

Capitalize & Valorize

- ✓ **Highlight these actions** in project decks and touchpoints.
- ✓ **Reuse quotes/mentions as social proof** (“featured in...”, “interviewed by...”, “recommended by...”).
- ✓ **Produce a synthesis of impact**: traffic, contacts, sign-ups, positive feedback.

Expected Deliverables (Non-exhaustive)

- ✓ **Links to articles/interviews/publications/podcasts/talks.**
- ✓ **Screenshots/videos of public event participation.**
- ✓ **LinkedIn page or project showcase** (site, mini-portfolio, platform profile).
- ✓ **External testimonials/quotes** to valorize.
- ✓ **Traffic/engagement data** related to these actions (Analytics, interactions).
- ✓ **A “social proof” slide** to insert in decks.

What Is Not Sufficient

- ✓ Being “visible on Discord only” or only in the Epitech community.
- ✓ Having an inactive LinkedIn page or no project-related posts.
- ✓ Reusing internal content (Discord post, internal email) as reputation proof.
- ✓ Talking about an event without participating or public interaction.
- ✓ Presenting assets with no outcomes, audience, or visible trace.

v1

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